

EXPLORING AND CREATING IN THE ARTS

OVERVIEW

Exploring and Creating in the Arts focuses on creating, presenting, and promoting art works, including integrated art works and productions, for a variety of purposes. Students use a variety of tools, techniques, and technologies to create art works and productions that communicate messages and demonstrate their creative skills. Students analyse works from various arts disciplines and create art works or productions that integrate aspects of these disciplines.

In exploring the arts and creating art works, students explore the interrelationship between the arts and personal development. They respond to creative challenges using elements, principles, materials, and techniques from various arts disciplines, including dance, drama, media arts, music, and visual arts. This course encourages creative expression and fosters the development of skills and knowledge that prepare students for lifelong learning and participation in the arts and arts-related activities.

The expectations for the course in exploring the arts and creating art works are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students apply the creative process (see pages 15–17) to produce and present art works/productions using materials and elements and/or principles from more than one arts discipline. Students use technologies, tools, and techniques associated with these disciplines to create, modify, present, and promote integrated art works/productions for a variety of purposes.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) to analyse and assess a variety of art works/productions. Students examine the function of the arts in society and analyse how the arts have affected their personal values and sense of identity, generating a deeper understanding of themselves and their culture. They explore arts-related careers and opportunities outside the classroom.
3. ***Foundations:*** In this strand, students develop their understanding of, and use proper terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other key concepts related to various arts disciplines. They explore symbols and themes in the arts as well as influences on various arts disciplines. Students learn about responsible practices and ethical considerations associated with creating and experiencing different types of art works and apply these practices when creating, presenting, experiencing, and promoting art works/productions.

Exploring and Creating in the Arts, Grade 11 or 12

Open

AEA30/AEA40

This course offers students the opportunity to explore connections between dance, drama, media arts, music, and/or visual arts. Students will use the creative process individually and/or collaboratively to produce integrated art works that draw on various disciplines, and they will critically analyse art works and determine how interpreting these works affects their own development. Students will develop responsible practices that are transferable beyond the classroom. They will explore solutions to integrated arts challenges and discover that art is everywhere, influencing and reflecting society.

Prerequisite: Any Grade 9 or 10 arts course

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process to create integrated art works/productions, individually and/or collaboratively;
- A2. Elements and Principles:** apply elements and principles from various arts disciplines when creating, modifying, and presenting art works, including integrated art works/productions;
- A3. Tools, Techniques, and Technologies:** use a variety of tools, techniques, and technologies to create integrated art works/productions that communicate specific messages and demonstrate creativity;
- A4. Presentation and Promotion:** present and promote art works, including integrated art works/productions, for a variety of purposes, using appropriate technologies and conventions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use a variety of strategies (*e.g., brainstorming with a partner, think-pair-share, mind maps, graphic organizers*) to generate innovative ideas and to develop and refine detailed plans to address an integrated art challenge, individually and/or collaboratively (*e.g., the challenge to create a performance piece or installation on a theme related to nature, such as water, fire, birth, or decay*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies did your group use to generate ideas to address the creative challenge?” “Does your plan address how you will approach all the stages of the creative process as you create your art work?” “In what ways did you have to refine your original idea and plans as you progressed through the creative process?”

- A1.2** use the appropriate stages of the creative process to produce and present integrated art works, individually and/or collaboratively, in response to creative challenges, and revise them on the basis of reflection and peer- and self-assessment (*e.g., experiment with elements from various arts disciplines; present their work formally and informally to the class at various stages of the creative process, reflect on the insights derived from the audience response, and use valid feedback as well as self-assessment to refine their work*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you decide if an experiment with integrating elements from various arts has been successful?” “When you reflect on your approach to the creative process, was any stage more demanding than the others?” “Has peer feedback given you fresh ideas to explore? Has it changed your perception of or approach to your work? What changes did you make as a result of this feedback?”

- A1.3** compile and organize a portfolio that contains representative samples of their integrated art works/productions and illustrates how they have used the creative process in creating these works (*e.g., ensure that their portfolio includes evidence of how their work developed through each stage of the creative process*)

Teacher prompts: “Does your portfolio contain a range of work that illustrates your approach to each stage of the creative process? Which works reflect the specific stages of the process?” “Why is it important to include preliminary as well as final versions of your work in your portfolio?”

A2. Elements and Principles

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** select and apply a combination of elements and principles from multiple arts disciplines when creating and presenting complex integrated art works/productions (*e.g., use relationship*

from dance, timbre and texture from music, and unity and harmony from visual arts to highlight the connections between different life forms on Earth; present an art work that combines interactivity and duration from media arts with time and space from drama and time and energy from dance)

Teacher prompts: “How could you visually complement the pitch and dynamics of this piece of music using elements from dance and drama?” “How would you approach the elements of energy and tension in this work to create a cohesive art work?”

A2.2 research how artists have modified existing art works to create new art works (e.g., how Tom Stoppard’s *Rosencrantz and Guildenstern Are Dead* draws on characters from *Hamlet*; how Andy Warhol used photographs in his visual art works; how Akira Kurosawa uses conventions from Kabuki theatre in his films; how Antonin Dvorak used themes from traditional Slavic and American music in his art music), and, using this research as inspiration, modify the elements and/or principles of an existing art work to create a new work whose intent and impact are different from those of the original work

Teacher prompts: “How have visual artists such as Charles Pachter or Betye Saar challenged the meaning of cultural icons? When might a similar approach be appropriate in your own work?” “Who are some popular songwriters who have used themes from art music in their compositions? Are there any themes from the music you have studied that you could adapt for use in your own composition or improvisation? How might you modify such a theme? What factors influence your approach?”

A3. Tools, Techniques, and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 integrate media/materials, tools, and techniques from more than one arts discipline to create a complex integrated art work/production that communicates a specific message (e.g., create two public service announcements on the same current social issue but intended for different audiences; create a podcast or other multimedia production on an issue of personal interest)

Teacher prompts: “How might you use an integrated art work to draw attention to social/political issues? What techniques might

you use to enhance your message?” “Why might an integrated art work be particularly effective at conveying a message to an audience?”

A3.2 use technologies, tools, and techniques associated with more than one arts discipline to create integrated art works/productions that demonstrate creativity and/or innovation (e.g., use accompaniment and animation software to create an innovative art work based on an environmental theme; used digitized sound- and video-editing techniques to create an experimental film; use computer-assisted design software and design techniques to create an innovative interior design for an advertising agency)

Teacher prompts: “What are the criteria for determining whether an art work or production demonstrates creativity, uniqueness, or innovation?” “In what ways has working with current technologies allowed you to explore and extend the limits of innovation in your art works?”

A4. Presentation and Promotion

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 apply a variety of current technologies to present integrated art works/productions (e.g., present the class’s integrated art works in a virtual gallery; display digitized visual art works on the stage to enhance a music, dance, or drama presentation; present a screen dance that complements a pre-recorded, original digital soundtrack)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the advantages and disadvantages associated with presenting your integrated art works in a virtual environment? How can you assess the response to works presented in this way?”

A4.2 use a collaborative approach to plan, design, and produce a year-end group presentation of selected art works, including integrated art works (e.g., select works that demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of the creative process and that represent all the arts disciplines; generate strategies for display/presentation that best suit the individual works and that present the works as a cohesive whole)

Teacher prompts: “What considerations do you need to address when selecting works for a collaborative culminating presentation?” “How can the various works be organized in a way that enhances the individual works but also contributes to a unified presentation?”

A4.3 demonstrate an understanding of the appropriate standards, conventions, and practices associated with the preparation, promotion, and presentation of art works, including integrated art works/productions, for a variety of purposes (*e.g., standards and conventions for the display of various types of visual art works; practices to ensure an appropriate level of interactivity in media art works; standards associated with venues for dance or drama presentations;*

different standards and practices for formal and informal presentations; practices used to effectively promote an exhibition of integrated art works in the local community)

Teacher prompts: “How would you promote integrated art works/productions being presented at a community centre or gallery as opposed to those being presented to an audience of students at your school?” “What are the advantages and disadvantages of promoting or presenting works solely on the Internet?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by applying it to study works from various arts disciplines as well as integrated art works/productions;
- B2. The Function of the Arts in Society:** explain and assess the functions and impact of the arts in past and present societies;
- B3. The Arts and Personal Development:** demonstrate an understanding of the interrelationship between the arts and personal development, including their own personal development;
- B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of and apply the types of skills developed through creating, presenting, and analysing art works, including integrated art works/productions, and describe various opportunities to pursue artistic endeavours outside the classroom.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe their initial reaction to works from a variety of arts disciplines, and explain the reasons for their reaction (*e.g., aspects of the work and their personal experience or values that contributed to their reaction*)

Teacher prompt: “What particular aspects of this art work most affected your initial impression? Why do you think this aspect of the work had an impact on you?”

- B1.2** identify and describe the elements and principles used to create integrated art works, and analyse the methods used to combine these elements and principles into unified art works (*e.g., write a review of an installation, including a description of how the artist combined elements from various arts disciplines; create a mind map of the artistic elements in a music video by contemporary First Nation, Métis, or Inuit musicians, and analyse how these elements have been combined into a cohesive whole*)

Teacher prompts: “What elements from the arts are integrated into an operatic performance?”
“When you study this installation, what elements can you identify? Which arts disciplines are

they taken from? How does the combination of these elements allow the work to transcend these disciplines?”

- B1.3** interpret a variety of art works using the critical analysis process, and reflect on and explain how their interpretation of specific art works has changed over the course of this process (*e.g., the difference between their initial reaction and more informed interpretation; the roles of research and reflection in their ongoing critical assessment*)

Teacher prompt: “Describe your initial reaction to this art work. In what ways has this reaction changed as a result of your increased understanding of the artist’s intent? What factors contributed to this change?”

- B1.4** communicate their critical judgement of a variety of their own art works and the works of others, and explain the relationship between this stage of the critical analysis process and the creative process (*e.g., why a work is or is not effective; what they would change in a work, and why; how evaluating the effectiveness of others’ art works contributes to their ability to assess their own works at different stages of the creative process*)

Teacher prompts: “What aspects of this art work do you think are effective? Why? Are there any aspects that you consider ineffective? Why?” “What criteria can we use for evaluating art works? How can you apply these criteria when engaged in the creative process to enhance the effectiveness of your work?”

B2. The Function of the Arts in Society

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 explain various functions of the arts in society, with reference to both past and present societies (e.g., *prepare an integrated arts presentation to explain the function of the arts with respect to ritual, entertainment, education, or cultural expression; report on the functions of art in Aboriginal societies; compare the functions of the arts in ancient and contemporary societies*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the meaning of Marshall McLuhan’s statement ‘The medium is the message’? How is it related to the function of the arts in society?” “What role do songs play in oral cultures?”

B2.2 assess, on the basis of research, the ability of the arts to inform and instruct and to contribute to social change (e.g., *the impact of works intended to manipulate, didactic works, propaganda, works of social or political protest; the influence of artists such as Augusto Boal, Bertold Brecht, Miriam Makeba, Alanis Obomsawin, Pablo Picasso, John Heartfield, Bruce Mau; the impact of contemporary podcasts or random access web videos on politics or cultural issues*)

Teacher prompts: “Who are some Canadian artists who are particularly associated with social commentary or criticism? What impact has their work had?” “Name some artists whose work has been censored, and explain why their work met with this response.” “In what ways is digital technology changing the ability of the arts to contribute to social change?” “In what ways can a viral web video affect an election campaign?”

B3. The Arts and Personal Development

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 analyse how creating, presenting, and analysing a variety of art works has affected their personal values and their understanding of the values of their community and culture and those of other cultures (e.g., *how using the newspaper as a source of ideas for an art work contributed to their understanding of the importance of an issue in their community; how analysing art*

works from around the globe on the Internet has contributed to their understanding of and appreciation for other cultures; how their understanding of issues of importance to other cultures has affected their own values)

Teacher prompts: “What have you learned about your personal biases from creating your art works?” “In what ways did you adapt to different points of view when working on collaborative creative projects?” “Have any of the art works you have studied challenged your assumptions about other cultures? If so, how?”

B3.2 analyse, on the basis of research, the impact of a range of factors on the development of artists from various arts disciplines (e.g., *the impact of mental health issues on the work of Vincent van Gogh or of physical disability on the work of Chuck Close or Evelyn Glennie; the impact of changing technologies on the work of Michael Snow; the influence of Aboriginal culture on the work of Santee Smith; the impact of gender roles on various women artists*), and describe factors that have contributed to their own development as an artist

Teacher prompts: “What impact did traditional gender roles have on the career and artistic output of a composer such as Clara Schumann or a visual artist such as Emily Carr?” “What would you change about one of your earlier art works to demonstrate your artistic growth?”

B4. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B4.1 demonstrate an understanding of, and apply both inside and outside the arts classroom, skills, character traits, and work habits that are developed through the processes of creating, analysing, presenting, and promoting collaborative and independent art works, including integrated art works/productions (e.g., *create a word wall of character traits useful in integrated arts; in small groups, demonstrate leadership skills related to task planning, organizing, and delegating; demonstrate effective oral communication skills; compare the skills required to produce, present, or analyse work in integrated arts and those required in other classes or extracurricular activities; demonstrate skills included in the Ontario Skills Passport or among the Human Resources and Skills Development Canada [HRSDC] essential skills*)

Teacher prompt: “How might you use skills learned in this course to organize a community event to showcase student work? How can these same planning, organizational, and promotional skills be used in other areas of study or in your part-time job?”

B4.2 describe, on the basis of research, arts-related careers and secondary and postsecondary pathways that reflect their interests and skills (*e.g., reflect on their interests, conduct personal skills inventories, and research employment opportunities that reflect their interests and skills; explore college and university arts programs and arts-related apprenticeships; compile a list of arts organizations in their community and the types of career opportunities available with them*)

Teacher prompts: “What arts-related career opportunities that are of interest to you exist in our community? What types of educational background and work experience do they require?” “What arts career opportunity most interests you? What skills do you see as necessary in order to succeed in this area?”

B4.3 describe, on the basis of research, opportunities for continuing engagement in artistic and cultural endeavours beyond the classroom (*e.g., student subscription packages for local dance troupes, theatre groups, music ensembles; local artist talks or art gallery tours; opportunities for involvement in arts advocacy, either with a local group or nationally/internationally through the Internet; volunteer opportunities with local festivals*)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways does the Internet expand opportunities for you to become involved in arts advocacy?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use proper terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other concepts related to various arts disciplines;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of symbols and themes associated with art works produced by various cultures from around the globe and of past and present influences on works from various arts disciplines;
- C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of conventions and responsible practices associated with various arts disciplines, and apply these practices when creating, presenting, experiencing, and promoting art works.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** use, appropriately and correctly, terminology related to elements, principles, and other key concepts from all the arts disciplines when creating, analysing, or presenting various types of art works (*e.g., use terminology correctly when using technology to create a melodic phrase to complement a visual art work or series of dance movements, when creating an art installation, when analysing a sculpture, when staging a play; design a “terminology bingo” game using a wide range of terms describing the elements and principles related to all the arts*)
- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of elements, principles, and other key concepts associated with all the arts disciplines, and identify those that are common to more than one discipline (*e.g., in small groups, generate a list of concepts from all arts disciplines for a word wall; create a Venn diagram to determine common concepts; explain terms such as line, point of view, time, balance, interactivity, and variety with reference to specific arts disciplines*)
- C1.3** analyse similarities and differences in approaches to the creative process in various arts disciplines (*e.g., how a musician, a choreographer, and a sculptor might approach the planning/incubation stage; how a visual artist and a musician*

might experiment with the elements of their art; how a dramatist and a media artist might present their work; how the revision process differs across the various arts disciplines)

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of symbols used in a variety of past and present art works from various cultures from around the world (*e.g., research and report on the significance of symbols associated with ancient Egyptian or Roman statuary; First Nation, Métis, and Inuit pictographs; Balinese dance; Celtic ballads; commercial icons*)
Teacher prompts: “What types of symbols are used in this advertising icon? Why are these symbols used?” “What are some symbols used in the lyrics of religious music?”
- C2.2** research, reflect on, and explain how common themes (*e.g., love, war, heroism, death, joy, work, nature*) are addressed in a variety of past and present art works from various cultures
Teacher prompts: “What are some different ways in which artists have portrayed the theme of love?” “What are some of the ways in which Canadian artists, including Québécois and First Nation, Métis, and Inuit artists, have addressed the theme of nationhood?”

C2.3 demonstrate an understanding of how past and present social, economic, and/or political factors have affected artistic form and content (e.g., *how political factors influenced the content of propaganda films from World War II; how social, economic, and political factors affected the visual arts, music, drama, and/or dance of the Renaissance; how environmental issues have influenced various contemporary artists; how industrialization resulted in new artistic forms and technologies*)

Teacher prompts: “What impact did the social and economic disruption associated with the Great Depression have on music, visual arts, or drama in Canada?” “In what ways did the social and economic changes associated with the Industrial Revolution affect the content and form of art works?”

C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 demonstrate an understanding of and apply conventions associated with the experiencing of various types of art works (e.g., *the etiquette associated with dance and drama, interactive media art, various types of concerts, museums/galleries*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the conventions traditionally associated with attending art exhibitions? In what ways are some media artists challenging these conventions?” “How and why might audiences behave differently at a rock concert, a jazz concert, and an art music concert?”

C3.2 demonstrate an understanding of safe and conscientious work practices associated with various arts disciplines, and apply these practices when engaged in the creative process (e.g., *demonstrate familiarity with Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System [WHMIS] guidelines; show respect for the work of other students; apply safe practices when working with various tools and materials; use group discussion and consensus to determine effective rules and expectations in the integrated arts classroom*)

Teacher prompts: “What sorts of substances should not be used in the classroom? Which substances should be used only with protective equipment?” “Why is it important to warm up properly before a dance routine or before singing?”

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of ethical and legal practices related to the various arts disciplines, and apply these practices when creating, presenting, or promoting art works, including integrated art works / productions (e.g., *use media from Creative Commons; obtain permission to sample songs or use stock photography; acknowledge their sources when borrowing from the work of other artists; show respect and sensitivity when appropriating from other cultures*)

Teacher prompts: “What issues should you consider before appropriating symbols or motifs associated with other cultures in your art work?” “How would you go about getting permission to include in your film soundtrack a piece of music written by another composer?”

C3.4 describe environmental issues associated with the arts, and apply environmentally responsible practices when creating, presenting, and promoting art works, including integrated art works/productions (e.g., *safely and appropriately dispose of paint containers, toner cartridges, and other arts supplies; recycle batteries; use the Environment Canada website as a source for an integrated arts project on the four R’s [reduce, reuse, recycle, and recover]; reduce the use of paper by promoting a performance or art exhibition through the Internet*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to check the source the supplies you use for your art works?” “Are any of the items you used in creating your art work classified as hazardous waste? How should you dispose of them?”